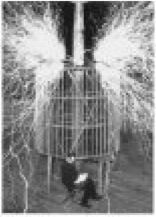


Tesla, the showman, in a 1899 double-exposure photograph, demonstrating high-frequency phenomena.

Nikola Tesla

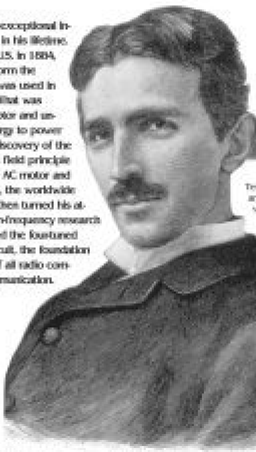
A model of Tesla's first AC motor/generator patented in 1888.

"Were we to seize and eliminate from our industrial world the results of Mr. Tesla's work, the wheels of industry would cease to turn." —B. A. Behrend

A prolific inventor of keen intelligence and exceptional insight, Tesla patented more than 500 inventions in his lifetime. He was born in Croatia and immigrated to the U.S. in 1884, bringing with him a discovery that would transform the world. By 1874, direct current (DC) technology was used in many industries, but only with minor success. What was needed was an alternating current (AC) motor and unlimited electrical energy to power industry. Tesla's discovery of the rotating magnetic field principle brought forth the AC motor and polyphase AC, the worldwide standard. He then turned his attention to high-frequency research and discovered the fourtuned circuit, the foundation of all radio communication.

Tesla's turn-of-the-century antenna concept for worldwide communication located at Shoreham, Long Island, NY. Financier J. P. Morgan withdrew funding and the tower was never completed.

The first modern polyphase AC generating station harnessed the power of Niagara Falls in 1895, utilizing Tesla's seminal AC patents. When completely operational in 1902, it surpassed all the electrical power generated by 31 states, initiating the age of modern electrical power.



1856 July 10, Nikola Tesla born in Smiljan, Croatia.

1882—Tesla discovers the rotating magnetic field principle, the scientific breakthrough which produced the AC motor and the method for generating polyphase AC.

1884—Tesla tries to convince Edison of the advantages of AC power. Edison could not see any merit in it.

1886—Tesla forms the Tesla Electric Light Co. and makes a significant improvement in arc lighting, earning his seven patents.

1887—The Western Union Telegraph Company helps Tesla form a business. In the next few years he produces designs for split-phase, induction, and synchronous motors and generators.

1888—Tesla secures basic patents for the polyphase AC system still in use today. He lectures to A.I.E.E. on his AC system. George Westinghouse purchases Tesla's AC patents.

1891—Tesla demonstrates his high frequency, high voltage Tesla coil to the A.I.E.E. He becomes a U.S. citizen.

1897—Tesla patents the four-tuned circuit, making radio a viable technology.

1898—Tesla patents the first wireless robotics, a radio-controlled model boat.

1903—Tesla patents the AND logic gate principle, which is incorporated in all digital computer systems.

1928—Tesla patents the VTOL aircraft.

1943 Tesla dies on January 7. The U.S. Supreme Court overturns the Marconi patent for the invention of radio, granting Tesla full rights for the invention. Marconi had utilized Tesla's fundamental patent No. 645,576 when he signaled across the Atlantic.

1956—Electrotechnical Conference designates the Tesla (T) to represent the "Unit of Magnetic Flux Density."